

LEO CLUB PRESIDENTS TRAINING

2025 / 2026

Leo District 306 D7 | Leadership - Experience - Opportunity



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THE LIONS AND LEO MOVEMENT

Lions Clubs International (LCI)

- Founded by Melvin Jones in 1917 - world's largest service organization (1.4M members)
- 46,000+ clubs across 200+ countries | Slogan: "We Serve"
- Mission areas: Vision, Hunger, Environment, Pediatric Cancer, Disaster Relief

Leo Club Program

- Founded December 5, 1957 - youth wing of LCI for ages 12-30
- 7,200+ Leo Clubs in 150+ countries | Motto: Leadership - Experience - Opportunity
- Develops leadership, planning, and social skills through community service

Leo Multiple District 306 — Sri Lanka and Maldives

- Redistricted in 2025 into 12 districts: D1, D2, D3, D4, D5, D6, D7, D8, D9, D10, D11, D12
- Leo District 306 D7: One of the largest and most active districts

CLUB ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

Club President — Key Decision Maker

Sets direction, tone, and goals for the entire club year

Leo Advisor

Provides Senior Lions guidance on club activities

Staff Advisor

Institutional/faculty advisor providing administrative support

Immediate Past President

Ensures continuity and serves as institutional memory resource

Vice President

Supports President; assumes role in President's absence

Secretary and Assistants

Handles communications, minutes, reports, and records

Treasurer and Assistants

Manages finances, budget, dues, and financial reporting

Board of Directors

Core governing body that approves decisions and drives projects

Past Presidents

Advisory council — mentorship and institutional knowledge

Members

The heart of the club — active participants in all service projects

ROLE OF THE CLUB PRESIDENT

Core Responsibilities

- Understand Leo club purposes and ethics — set the tone for the club
- Set annual goals in conjunction with the board of directors
- Prepare detailed agendas for each meeting with the secretary and Leo Advisor
- Chair all meetings — encourage participation and maintain order

Key Actions

- Delegate: appoint committee chairpersons with clear guidelines and regular check-ins
- Maintain communication with the sponsoring Lions club and Leo Advisor
- Encourage members to engage at Zone, Region, District, and Multiple District level

Qualities of a Strong President

- Trustworthy - Skilled - Fair - Visionary - Accountable – Inclusive
- Energy, self-confidence, persistence, and ability to inspire others

RUNNING EFFECTIVE MEETINGS

BEFORE the Meeting

- Identify objectives — is this meeting truly necessary?
- Arrange a convenient date, time, and venue
- Send the agenda and notice well in advance

DURING the Meeting

- Arrive early — ensure venue and materials are ready
- Start on time — stick to the agenda at all times
- Record minutes and action items (very important!)
- Appreciate contributions; use gavel to maintain discipline
- Never leave the chairman's seat empty

AFTER the Meeting

- Circulate minutes at the earliest opportunity
- Follow up on all action items that were assigned
- Send thank-you notes to contributors
- Remind members of the next meeting date

Meeting Best Practices

- Limit meetings to 45-60 minutes maximum
- Three Phases: Plan - Execute - Follow Up
- Speak clearly; avoid jargon and tangents
- Organize something different to keep members engaged

OUTSIDE THE CLUB AND THE EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

You Are the Face of Your Club

- Your words and behaviour directly reflect your Leo Club and Leo District
- You are responsible for all your members and their conduct at all times
- When engaging externally: Be Responsible - Respectful - Clear Communicator

Working with Your Executive Committee

- Treat your exec committee as one family — unity is the bedrock of success
- Regularly compliment, recognize, and motivate your committee members
- Include everyone in decisions; delegate effectively with clear guidelines
- Maintain open, frequent, and two-way communication at all times

Building Team Unity

- You are the binding force — resolve conflicts swiftly and fairly
- Celebrate wins together — recognize effort, not just outcomes

GETTING STARTED — FIRST STEPS

Before You Take Office

- Attend Club Officer Training to understand your full responsibilities
- Meet with the outgoing president — discuss ongoing matters and commitments
- Set clear, measurable goals for your presidential term

Choose Your Committee Chairpersons

- Look for commitment, reliability, and passion in candidates
- Match skills to roles — brief chairpersons clearly; establish check-in cadence

Financial Setup

- Work with your treasurer to prepare administrative and activities budgets
- Select banking institution and establish petty cash reimbursement guidelines
- Set club dues to maintain the financial health of the club

Key Mindset for New Presidents

"Ask and learn what you do not know. Be the senior you needed when you were a junior."

ONGOING RESPONSIBILITIES DURING YOUR TERM

Club Administration

- Hold monthly board meetings and general meetings
- Submit monthly reports and keep MyLCI updated
- Respond to all correspondence within 24 hours
- Publish the club newsletter regularly

Projects and Service

- Help select and plan impactful service projects
- Track and report on all community service hours
- Pursue joint projects with other Leo clubs

Membership Growth

- Actively recruit new members — track monthly
- Attend zone, region, and district council meetings
- Review monthly membership and activity reports

Member Engagement

- Recognize and celebrate member contributions
- Foster inclusion — every Leo must feel valued
- Identify and develop next-year leadership early
- Plan fellowship events alongside service projects

YEAR PLANNING AND GOAL SETTING

Club Assessment — Start of Year

- Talk to the immediate past president — understand the club baseline
- Capture: membership count, projects done, meeting frequency, avg participation
- Identify strengths and weaknesses — address skill gaps through the year

Setting Expectations and Targets

- Set installation date, Leo 72 submission date, and membership target
- Define targeted number of projects, joint projects, and fundraising targets
- Schedule official visits: District President, VP, Region and Zone Directors

Monthly Administrative Tracking

- Board meetings | General meetings | Monthly reports | MyLCI updates
- Council meetings attended | Lions club meetings | Newsletter published

Action Plan Format

- For each goal: How (Action steps) - When (Deadline) - Who - How will we know?

CASE STUDIES — REAL CHALLENGES AND SOLUTIONS

Scenario 1: Declining Attendance

- Causes: Unengaging meetings, poor communication, members feeling undervalued
- Solutions: Revamp format, introduce social events, direct member outreach
- Risk if Unaddressed: Club stagnation, member churn, weakened district standing

Scenario 2: No District-Level Involvement

- Causes: Lack of awareness, travel/time barriers, no participation culture
- Solutions: Inform about zone/district events; lead by attending events yourself
- Risk if Unaddressed: Club isolation and missed recognition opportunities

Reflection Questions for New Presidents

- How will you promote the Leo mission in your community?
- What qualities do you look for in a committee chairperson?
- What are your top 3 goals for your presidential term?
- How will you build a culture of broad participation?

Key Principles to Remember

- Proactive leadership prevents most common club issues
- Regular communication builds trust and commitment
- Recognition drives engagement and member retention
- Succession planning ensures the club's long-term strength

YOU ARE NOW A LEO LEADER

Embrace the responsibility. Lead with purpose. Inspire your community.

LEADERSHIP

Set the direction. Be the example.

EXPERIENCE

Learn from every project and person.

OPPORTUNITY

Open doors for yourself and your members.

"Be the senior you needed when you were a junior." — Leo District 306 D7